



MCLAREN'S LANDO NORRIS RECOVERED FROM 10TH PLACE ON THE GRID AFTER HIS CRASH IN QUALIFYING TO FINISH FOURTH BEHIND FERRARI'S CHARLES LECLERC

Rookies Leonardo Fornaroli and Alexander Dunne continued their consistent runs, placing fourth and eighth respectively.

Arvid Lindblad followed up his sprint race win with a seventh-place finish, leaving Jeddah with a strong points haul. Indian racer Kush Maini finally opened his account for the season after two tough weekends.

In the F1 Academy, Ferrari's Maya Weug inherited the win in Race 2 following a penalty to Red Bull Ford's Chloe Chambers, adding to her second-place finish in Race 1.

The Spectacle in Corniche

The absence of high-drama crashes or a late Safety Car meant the race played out mostly through pit strategies. But off-track, the organisers delivered a strong entertainment package.

Jeddah's night race brought more than just the glow of floodlights –

fans enjoyed DJ sets, a Ferris wheel, fireworks, and a striking drone show.

The light show featured animated tributes to icons: a 1970s F1 car for Niki Lauda, Ayrton Senna's iconic yellow helmet, and seven trophies symbolising Michael Schumacher's titles.

The circuit remained busy throughout the weekend, with visitors enjoying concerts, paddock access, garage tours, pit walks, and rides on truck platforms.

The premium hospitality area

overlooking Turn 1 – the track's best overtaking spot – was the place to be. From there, fans could also see Turns 22 and 23, adjacent to the Al-Bahr Mosque, where drivers flick their cars through at high speed with only a slight brake tap.

While talks continue about building a permanent circuit on the Red Sea coast, the Corniche layout continues to challenge drivers and thrill fans alike.

(The writer was in Jeddah for the Saudi Arabian Grand Prix on the invitation of Saudi Motorsport)